Setting the Administrator Password

How to set, change or remove the password that signs in as the administrator of ImageSkinForLLM, on a laptop (Windows 10, Windows 11 or Mac) and on the hosted site on Oracle Cloud.

The short version

1. The password is set in a file, `admin.toml`, on the computer that runs the app. There is no sign-up and no way to set or change it in the app: only someone who can sign in to that computer can.
2. Copy the template `admin.example.toml`, from the top of the project folder, to where the app looks for `admin.toml`, and put the password in it.
3. Save the file. The app reads it again by itself: **no restart is needed**, and the new password works at once.
4. Sign in on the app's **Settings** page, under **Administrator**.

Time needed: about 5 minutes.

> **Never commit `admin.toml`.** It holds the password. The project's `.gitignore` keeps it out of git; only the empty template, `admin.example.toml`, is in the repository.

Where the file goes

Where the app runs	The file
Windows 10 or 11	`C:\Users\`*you*`\.imageskin\admin.toml` (`%USERPROFILE%\.imageskin\admin.toml`)
Mac	`~/.imageskin/admin.toml` (`/Users/`*you*`/.imageskin/admin.toml`)
The hosted site (Docker on Oracle Cloud)	`~/ImageSkinForLLM/deploy/admin/admin.toml` on the machine

The `.imageskin` folder is the app's home folder, made the first time the app runs. If `IMAGESKIN_HOME` is set, the file goes in that folder instead. A config file can also name another place with `admin_file = "..."` (see `config.example.toml`); the hosted site's `deploy/config.toml` does this, pointing at the `deploy/admin` folder.

What to write in the file

The file has two lines. Fill in one of them.

```
password_hash = ""
password = ""
```

Best: a hash of the password

A hash lets the app check the password without the password itself being stored on the disk. Make it with the app's own command, typing the password twice (nothing shows as you type):

```
imageskin admin-password-hash
```

It prints a line such as

```
password_hash = "scrypt$16384$8$1$Qm9vbXNoYWth...$9yGd7z...="
```

Paste that whole line into `admin.toml` in place of its `password_hash = ""` line, and save. Run the command in the project's Python environment, the same way you run `imageskin serve`; on the hosted site, run it in the app's container (below).

Or: the password as it is

```
password = "a long passphrase you will remember"
```

This is simpler, but anyone who can read the file can read the password, so keep the file readable only by you (below). If both lines are filled in, the hash is used.

> **A password with a backslash (\) or a double quote (")** needs care in this file format. Use single quotes instead, `password = 'my "quoted" pass\word'` , or use the hash, which never has them.

On a Windows 10 or 11 laptop

1. Open **Command Prompt** and go to the project folder (where `admin.example.toml` is), for example:

   ```
   cd %USERPROFILE%\github\ImageSkinForLLM
   ```

2. Copy the template into the app's home folder:

   ```
   mkdir "%USERPROFILE%\.imageskin"
   copy admin.example.toml "%USERPROFILE%\.imageskin\admin.toml"
   ```

   (`mkdir` says the folder already exists if the app has run before; that's fine.)

3. Make the hash, in the project's Python environment:

   ```
   .venv\Scripts\activate
   imageskin admin-password-hash
   ```

4. Open the file in Notepad, paste the `password_hash = "..."` line over the empty one, and save:

```
notepad "%USERPROFILE%\.imageskin\admin.toml"
```

5. Make the file readable only by you:

```
icacls "%USERPROFILE%\.imageskin\admin.toml" /inheritance:r /grant:r "%USERNAME%:F"
```

In PowerShell, the same steps are `New-Item -ItemType Directory -Force "$env:USERPROFILE\.imageskin"`, `Copy-Item admin.example.toml "$env:USERPROFILE\.imageskin\admin.toml"`, `.venv\Scripts\Activate.ps1`, `notepad "$env:USERPROFILE\.imageskin\admin.toml"` and `icacls "$env:USERPROFILE\.imageskin\admin.toml" /inheritance:r /grant:r "${env:USERNAME}:F"`.

On a Mac

1. Open **Terminal** and go to the project folder, for example:

```
cd ~/github/ImageSkinForLLM
```

2. Copy the template into the app's home folder and make it readable only by you:

```
mkdir -p ~/.imageskin
cp admin.example.toml ~/.imageskin/admin.toml
chmod 600 ~/.imageskin/admin.toml
```

3. Make the hash, in the project's Python environment:

```
source .venv/bin/activate
imageskin admin-password-hash
```

4. Open the file, paste the `password_hash = "..."` line over the empty one, and save (in nano, Ctrl+O, Enter, then Ctrl+X):

```
nano ~/.imageskin/admin.toml
```

On the hosted site (Oracle Cloud)

> **Two different passwords.** The hosted site already asks for a name and password before anything is shown (Caddy's, in `deploy/.env`; see `deploy/README.md`). That one lets anyone you give it to use the site. The administrator password here is a second one, inside the app, for the admin view only.

1. Connect to the machine from your laptop, as in step 4 of `deploy/README.md`, and go to the deploy folder:

```
ssh -i ~/.ssh/oracle.key ubuntu@your-machine's-address
cd ~/ImageSkinForLLM/deploy
```

2. **Once only**, after updating to the version with the admin view: get it and start the app again, so its container gets the `deploy/admin` folder:

```
git pull
docker compose up -d --build
```

   This is the only restart: later password changes need none.

3. Copy the template and make it readable only by you:

```
cp ../admin.example.toml admin/admin.toml
chmod 600 admin/admin.toml
```

   The app in its container runs as the same user as you on the machine (user 1000, `ubuntu`), so it can still read the file.

4. Make the hash in the app's container:

```
docker compose exec app imageskin admin-password-hash
```

5. Open the file, paste the line over the empty one, and save (Ctrl+O, Enter, Ctrl+X):

```
nano admin/admin.toml
```

6. Check the app found it: its log says `Admin password file read` with `"password_set": true` once the Settings page has been opened, or the Settings page offers the password field instead of saying signing in is off:

```
docker compose logs app | grep "Admin password file read"
```

Signing in and out

1. Open the app's **Settings** page (in either view) and scroll to **Administrator**.
2. Type the password and click **Sign in as administrator**. An **Admin** link appears in the top bar; it opens the admin view.
3. To sign out, click **Sign out as administrator** on the Settings page. Without a click or key press on the Settings page or in the admin view for 30 minutes (an admin setting), you are signed out by yourself, and the page says so.

After 5 failed sign-ins in a row, the next try waits a minute.

Changing, removing or forgetting the password

- **To change it:** make a new hash (or type the new password) and save the file over the old line. It works at once, with no restart. Anyone signed in with the old password is signed out, and the page says the password was changed.
- **To turn signing in off:** empty both lines (`password_hash = ""` and `password = ""`) or delete the file. Anyone signed in is signed out, and the Settings page says signing in as the administrator is off.
- **If it is forgotten:** there is no way to recover it, as the file holds only its hash. Whoever can sign in to the computer sets a new one, as above.

If it doesn't work

- **The Settings page says signing in as the administrator is off:** the app found no password. The file is in another folder, has another name (Windows may have saved it as `admin.toml.txt`: in Notepad, choose **All files** when saving), both lines are empty, or the file isn't valid. The log line `Admin password file read` shows the path the app reads and `password_set`; `Could not read the admin password file` gives the error.
- **"Admin login failed with error code A-…"** Every failed sign-in says only this, so that someone guessing learns nothing. The log line `Admin sign-in refused` with that code gives the reason, never the password: find it with `docker compose logs app | grep A-7K3F9Q` on the hosted site, using the code the page showed. The reason is `wrong password` (check for a space at the end, or a hash pasted only in part: it must be one line, in double quotes), `no password set`, or `waiting` after 5 failures in a row (wait a minute; the count starts again after a sign-in that works).
- **On the hosted site, a change isn't seen:** check you edited `deploy/admin/admin.toml` on the machine, and that `docker compose exec app cat /etc/imageskin/admin/admin.toml` shows the new line. If it says no such file, the container was started before step 2: run `docker compose up -d`.